

Vladimir Golubev

STAFF / SENIOR BACKEND ENGINEER

Backend engineer → tech lead. I'm the one fuzzy specs go to die.

13+ yrs backend engineering | 7,000 req/sec | stats core live 10+ yrs | payment gateways | microservices | MongoDB | PostgreSQL | AWS

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Summary

Backend engineer turned technical lead — 13+ years building, scaling and owning production systems, with team-leadership and lead/architect responsibilities since 2018. I design high-load distributed backends and I'm accountable for the architectural decisions behind them.

Plain version of what I do: requirements analysis and system design (I'd rather pick a fuzzy spec apart for an hour than ship a bug for a month), architecture trade-off decisions (monolith vs. microservices, relational SQL vs. column-store — I choose by load, not by trend), and the documentation, code review and testing discipline that keep systems alive for years.

PROOF POINTS

- Designed and scaled a multi-tenant **CPA (cost-per-action / affiliate marketing) platform** whose API peaked at **7,000 requests per second**.
- A real-time **statistics / analytics core** I architected in 2016 is still running in production a decade later.
- Integrated **four payment gateways end-to-end** (payment processing / billing integration).
- Early adopter of **ClickHouse** for analytics; drove team-wide adoption of Vue.js and Docker.

AI-augmented development as a default, not a novelty. I use Claude / Claude Code, ChatGPT, GitHub Copilot, Cursor and Codex daily, and I own the agentic harness end-to-end. I stress-test AI-assisted workflows in my solo indie game studio (nomorecare.gg (<https://nomorecare.gg>)), where I am sole architect, engineer and operator.

Core stack: PHP (5–8), system design, microservices, distributed systems, AWS, ClickHouse, Terraform, Docker, Redis; relational and NoSQL databases (MySQL, MariaDB, PostgreSQL, ClickHouse, MongoDB, Couchbase, DynamoDB, OpenSearch).

Open to Tech Lead, Software Architect and Staff Engineer roles where trade-offs and decisions matter more than volume of code. Remote-first, based in Novi Sad, Serbia. English C1, Russian native.

Work Experience

Senior Backend Engineer / Tech Lead — Quintegro · Jul 2022 – Jun 2026 · Remote Technical lead and senior backend engineer across a collectible-car ecosystem — multiple products: event-car rentals, US auction sites, an analytics platform, an RV marketplace. Served as tech lead on an event-car rental marketplace through its support phase; designed the seller-side deal-offer flow on an in-house PHP framework (PHP, jQuery, MariaDB). Built the backend for a data-heavy collectible-car analytics dashboard: subscription-based price-alert emails, currency converter, aggregated historical data blocks by car generation and model, and an authenticating request proxy. On a recreational-vehicle (RV) marketplace built on microservices: delivered automatic spam/abuse blocking, asynchronous image optimisation, CRUD admin tooling and notification flows; built a full local development environment for the entire microservice fleet enabling cross-service testing; rewrote the in-house DynamoDB library from raw arrays into a query-builder API; owned release management. Technical Leadership, System Design, Microservices, Distributed Systems, PHP, MariaDB, AWS, DynamoDB, OpenSearch, CloudWatch, Terraform, Release Management
Senior Backend Developer — Playkot · Jul 2021 – Jun 2022 · St. Petersburg Backend engineer on a live mobile-game backend under production traffic: implemented multi-provider authentication with account linking, and optimised partial-load / lazy-loading patterns over MongoDB for hot player data (performance optimisation under load). PHP, MongoDB, NoSQL, Authentication, Game Backend, Performance Optimization
Senior Backend Developer — Rabota.ru · Oct 2020 – Jun 2021 · St. Petersburg Backend engineer on one of Russia's largest job boards (high-traffic web platform): built the in-account customer notification service, migrated client-account features off a legacy codebase onto the new internal framework (legacy modernisation), and extended automated-test coverage across PostgreSQL-backed services. PHP, PostgreSQL, Notifications, Legacy Migration / Modernization, Test Automation

Lead Backend (PHP) Developer — Smart Line · Apr 2015 – Oct 2020 · St. Petersburg
Grew a small internal PHP utility into offergate.pro — a multi-tenant **CPA (cost-per-action / affiliate marketing) platform** with two product surfaces and a ClickHouse analytics stack.

Designed a real-time **statistics / analytics core** in 2016 that still runs in production today; the platform API peaked at **7,000 requests per second** (high-load system design).

Led a small backend team from 2018: code review, mentoring, architectural sign-off, and a team-wide rollout of automated testing.

Early ClickHouse adopter for analytics; initiated the team's migration to Vue.js and containerisation with Docker.

Integrated **four payment gateways end-to-end** — WebMoney, Platron, ePayments, bank131 (payment processing / billing integration).

Technical Leadership, Team Leadership, Mentoring, System Design, High-Load Systems, PHP 7, Vue.js, ClickHouse, MariaDB, Redis, Couchbase, Docker, Payment Gateway Integration

Full-Stack Engineer — TAXOFT · Jan 2013 – Mar 2015 · St. Petersburg
Designed, built and maintained the full software stack of a taxi-aggregator / ride-hailing service end-to-end — first hands-on exposure to production scale and on-call operations.

PHP, JavaScript, HTML, CSS, MySQL, Full-Stack Development

Projects

No More Care — Founder / Solo Engineer

nomorecare.gg → (https://nomorecare.gg)

Solo (one-person) indie game studio with three roguelike games in development — sole owner of design, software architecture, code, infrastructure and release.

Used as a **real-world test bed for agentic AI / LLM-assisted (“AI-in-the-loop”) development workflows.**

Skills

PINNED

System Design

High-Load Systems

Backend Engineering

architecture & systems System design, Software architecture, Distributed systems, Microservices, Monolithic architecture, High-load / high-throughput systems, Scalability, Performance optimization, API design, REST APIs

languages & runtime PHP (5, 7, 8), JavaScript, SQL, Python (beginner, pipelines)

data ClickHouse, MySQL, MariaDB, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Couchbase, DynamoDB, OpenSearch, Redis, NoSQL, Relational databases, Column-store databases, Database design

cloud & infra AWS, Docker, Terraform, CloudWatch, CI/CD, Linux, Infrastructure as Code

domains Payment gateway integration, Billing / payment processing, Affiliate / CPA platforms, Marketplaces, Analytics / statistics platforms, Game backends, Notifications

quality PHPUnit, Behat / BDD (behavior-driven development), Test automation, Technical documentation

leadership Technical leadership, Team leadership, Mentoring, Code review, Architectural sign-off / decision ownership, Release management

roles / seniority Technical Lead, Software Architect, Staff Engineer, Senior Backend Engineer, Engineering Team Lead

ai-augmented development Claude / Claude Code, ChatGPT, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Codex, Agentic AI, LLM-assisted development, Agentic frameworks, OpenHands SDK, LLM fine-tuning, Local LLM setup: OpenHands SDK + LM Studio, Python pipelines

frontend (working level) Vue.js, HTML, CSS, JavaScript

languages Russian (native), English (C1)

ALL SKILLS Backend Development, PHP, System Design, Software Architecture, Microservices, Distributed Systems, High-Load Systems, 7,000 req/sec, Scalability, Performance Optimization, API Design, ClickHouse, AWS, Docker, Terraform, Redis, MariaDB, PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Couchbase, DynamoDB, OpenSearch, Payment Gateway Integration, Release Management, Code Review, CI/CD, PHPUnit, BDD / Behat, Test Automation, Vue.js, Linux, AI-Augmented Development, OpenHands SDK, Python (beginner)